

Yes, you can set the `NEXT_LOCALE` cookie to override [Next.js built-in locale detection](#). This is a standard way to persist a user's language preference across sessions.  Stack Overflow +3

However, the implementation depends on whether you are working in a **Middleware**, **Server Component**, or **Client Component**: 

1. In Next.js Middleware

When using [Next.js Middleware](#), you cannot directly modify the *incoming* request cookies. Instead, you must set the cookie on the **response** object.  Medium +1

javascript



```
import { NextResponse } from 'next/server'

export function middleware(request) {
  const response = NextResponse.next()

  // Set the NEXT_LOCALE cookie on the response
  response.cookies.set('NEXT_LOCALE', 'fr', { path: '/' })

  return response
}
```

2. In Server Actions or Route Handlers

In the Next.js App Router, you can use the `cookies()` function to set values. Note that this must be awaited in newer versions.  Stack Overflow +1

javascript



```
'use server'
import { cookies } from 'next/headers'

export async function updateLocale(newLocale) {
  const cookieStore = await cookies()
  cookieStore.set('NEXT_LOCALE', newLocale)
}
```

3. In Client Components

Since `next/headers` is not available on the client, you can use standard browser APIs or a library like `js-cookie`.  Stack Overflow +1

javascript



```
// Using vanilla JavaScript
```

```
document.cookie = "NEXT_LOCALE=en; path=/; max-age=31536000; SameSite=Lax";
```

Important Considerations

- **Root Path Only:** By default, Next.js only checks the `NEXT_LOCALE` cookie when a user lands on the [root path](#) (`/`). If they land on a specific locale path (e.g., `/es/about`), the URL path takes precedence over the cookie.
- **next-intl Integration:** If you are using the [next-intl library](#), it handles this cookie automatically to remember the user's last detected or selected locale.
- **Domain Limits:** Cookies are restricted by the Same Origin Policy. If you use domain-specific routing (e.g., `.ca` and `.com`), a cookie set on one domain will not automatically apply to the other.  [GitHub](#) +4